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MAHATMA GHANDHI UNIVRSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU-BVOC (HONOURS) REGULAR EXAMINATIONSNOVEMBER 2025

FIRST SEMESTER

SKILL DEVELOPMENT COMPONENTS (SDC) - INTRODUCTION TO FASHION BUSINESS

(2025 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

1. What is the Trickle-Down Theory of fashion?

The trickle-down theory states that fashion trends start from the upper class or elite groups and are later adopted by the middle and lower classes. Once lower groups begin wearing the style, the elite move on to new fashions to maintain distinction.

2. Write two factors affecting the length of fashion cycle.

The fashion cycle is influenced by the buying power of consumers, which determines how quickly they adopt or reject styles, and social or cultural changes, which can speed up or slow down the popularity of a trend.

3. Define fashion business.

Fashion business is the industry involved in designing, producing, marketing, and selling apparel, accessories, and footwear. It combines creative design with commercial operations to deliver fashion products to consumers.

4. Mention one decorative and one practical accessory.

A decorative accessory is used to enhance appearance, such as a necklace. A practical accessory serves a functional purpose, such as a handbag used to carry personal items.

5. Mention any two purposes of clothing.

Clothing provides protection from environmental elements like heat or cold, and also offers modesty by covering the body according to cultural norms.

6. What roles media play in the final stage of forecasting?

Media publicizes upcoming trends, highlights designer collections, and influences customer awareness through magazines, TV, websites, and social media, helping trends reach the public.

7. Give any two ways to increase the response rate of Direct-mail questionnaire.

Response rates can be increased by keeping the questionnaire simple and short, and by offering incentives or providing prepaid return envelopes to encourage participation.

8. What is Target Market?

A target market is a specific group of customers a company wants to reach, selected based on demographics, lifestyle, income, or location.

9. Who is a fashion designer?

A fashion designer is a creative professional who develops clothing and accessories by deciding the silhouette, fabric, color, and style details for garments.

10. What is advertising? Give one example.

Advertising is a paid form of communication used to promote products or brands. For example, a fashion brand promoting its new collection through a magazine advertisement.

11. What is an online fashion business?

An online fashion business sells clothing, accessories, or footwear through e-commerce platforms such as Myntra, Ajio, or online brand websites.

PART B – 5 Marks (Question + Answer)

12. Name any two core components of the Modern Fashion Business.

Two important core components of modern fashion business are design and production, and marketing and merchandising. Design and production involve creating the garment, choosing fabrics, developing patterns, and manufacturing the final product. Marketing and merchandising focus on understanding consumer needs, planning collections, promoting products, and ensuring they reach the right customers at the right time. Together, these components help brands create attractive products and successfully sell them in the market.

13. Describe the features of fad fashion.

Fad fashion refers to styles that become popular very quickly and disappear just as fast. These fashions attract attention mainly because they are new, unique, or eye-catching. Fads spread rapidly among the youth due to media, influencers, and peer groups. Their life span is

extremely short—sometimes only a few weeks or months—because they lack long-lasting design value. Once consumer excitement fades, the fad disappears and is replaced by another temporary trend.

14. Write short notes on reverse adaptation with examples.

Reverse adaptation, also known as the trickle-up theory, explains how fashion trends start among lower-income groups or street culture and gradually move upward to high fashion. Instead of designers introducing new styles first, everyday people such as workers, youth, and subcultures influence the fashion industry. Designers adopt these styles, modify them, and present them on runways. Examples include jeans, which began as workwear for miners and later became worldwide fashion, and streetwear styles like hoodies and sneakers that have been adopted by luxury brands.

15. Explain the concept of prêt-à-porter in fashion.

Prêt-à-porter, or ready-to-wear, refers to clothing produced in standardized sizes and sold in a finished condition. These garments are manufactured in large quantities, making them more affordable and accessible than haute couture. Ready-to-wear collections are showcased during fashion weeks for each season and are available immediately in stores. They aim to balance designer creativity with practicality, offering fashionable clothing that can be worn without alterations.

16. Describe the role of supplier and manufacturer in fashion business.

Suppliers and manufacturers play key roles in the fashion industry. Suppliers provide raw materials such as fabrics, trims, buttons, zippers, and threads, and ensure that materials meet quality standards and delivery timelines. Manufacturers convert these materials into finished garments through cutting, sewing, assembling, and finishing. They maintain size accuracy, quality control, and production deadlines. Both are essential for smooth, efficient garment production.

17. Mention any four categories of kid’s wear with suitable examples.

Kids’ wear includes several categories based on age and needs. Babywear consists of onesies and rompers designed for newborn comfort. Boys’ wear includes shirts, jeans, T-shirts, and shorts suitable for daily activities. Girls’ wear offers dresses, skirts, leggings, and tunics that are comfortable and stylish. School uniforms include shirts, pants, skirts, and pinafores worn by children in educational institutions. These categories focus on safety, comfort, and practicality.

18. Explain how trend forecasting differs from fashion forecasting. Provide examples.

Trend forecasting is a broad study of consumer behavior, cultural changes, and lifestyle patterns across various industries such as food, technology, interiors, and fashion. It predicts long-term societal movements. Fashion forecasting, however, focuses specifically on predicting future clothing trends such as colors, fabrics, silhouettes, and textures for upcoming seasons. For example, a trend forecast may identify rising concern for sustainability, while a fashion forecast may predict natural tones and organic fabrics as upcoming fashion trends.

19. Describe how Trade fairs help in gathering forecasting information.

Trade fairs help gather forecasting information by introducing new fabrics, colors, textures, and technological innovations. Designers and buyers attend these fairs to observe what suppliers and manufacturers are offering for future seasons. Trade fairs allow brands to understand upcoming market directions, assessment of consumer interest, and insights into competitor strategies. This helps companies in planning collections and staying updated with industry trends.

20. Describe two ways in which forecasting improves coordination and control.

Forecasting improves coordination by ensuring all departments—design, production, and marketing—work according to the same future plan, reducing confusion and improving teamwork. It improves control by helping businesses plan materials, manage inventory, and schedule production efficiently. Accurate forecasting prevents wastage, overproduction, and financial loss.

21. What is Research & Observation, Data Collection and Validation in Fashion Forecasting Framework?

Research and observation involve studying culture, lifestyles, street fashion, and social influences to identify emerging trends. Data collection gathers information through surveys, interviews, fashion shows, magazines, and sales records. Validation checks whether predictions are correct by testing sample garments, collecting feedback, and making adjustments before final decisions. These steps ensure reliable forecasting.

PART C – 10 Marks (Question + Answer)

22. Explain how understanding fashion cycle stages helps fashion marketers and designers.

Understanding the five stages of the fashion cycle—introduction, rise, peak, decline, and rejection—is essential for both marketers and designers. During the introduction stage, designers release new styles and marketers target early adopters. As the style gains popularity in the rise stage, production increases and promotional activities expand. At the peak stage, the trend becomes widely accepted, so marketers use strong advertising while designers may introduce variations to extend interest. In the decline stage, demand decreases and marketers shift to discounting strategies. During the rejection stage, the style becomes outdated, requiring retailers to clear old stock and designers to introduce fresh styles. This understanding helps brands plan production, pricing, inventory, and marketing strategies effectively.

23. Discuss the various categories of women's wear with examples.

Women's wear includes a wide range of clothing for various occasions. Tops include shirts, tunics, blouses, and crop tops suitable for casual and formal use. Bottoms such as trousers, skirts, jeans, leggings, and palazzos offer comfort and versatility. Dresses including maxi, A-line, and cocktail styles are worn for parties, work, and casual outings. Ethnic wear like sarees, salwar suits, lehengas, and anarkalis is preferred for festivals and traditional events. Outerwear such as coats, jackets, and blazers provide warmth and style. Lingerie and nightwear ensure comfort, while sportswear like yoga pants and active tops support fitness activities. Accessories such as scarves, handbags, and jewellery enhance the overall outfit.

24. Explain the two main types of fashion forecasting – long-term and short-term.

Long-term forecasting predicts major cultural, social, technological, and economic shifts that influence fashion over two to five years. It focuses on broad trends such as sustainability, lifestyle changes, and technological innovations. Brands use long-term forecasts for planning strategy, market positioning, and fabric development. Short-term forecasting focuses on details like colors, fabrics, textures, prints, and silhouettes for the upcoming six to eighteen months. It relies on fashion shows, trade fairs, street style, and celebrity influence. Designers use short-term forecasts for creating seasonal collections. Both forecasting types together help brands create successful products.

25. Describe the various methods of promotion used by fashion companies to attract and retain customers.

Fashion companies use several promotional methods to increase visibility and sales. Advertising through magazines, television, social media, and billboards helps reach large audiences. Sales promotions such as discounts, seasonal offers, and coupons attract

consumers and increase purchases. Public relations activities including fashion shows, sponsorships, and press releases help maintain a strong brand image. Personal selling occurs in stores where employees assist customers with styling and product selection. Direct marketing uses SMS, emails, and catalogues to send personalized information to customers. Digital marketing through influencers, Instagram, Facebook, and YouTube has become a major tool for brand promotion. Visual merchandising uses attractive window displays and store layouts to encourage impulse buying. These methods help brands attract new customers and retain existing ones.